

Oborcopy User Guide

Back up and mirror your folders – safely and step by step

Version 1.0.0 · for Windows 10/11 and Linux

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1. What is Oborcopy?

Oborcopy keeps a **copy of a folder up to date** – for example your music collection on one disk and its backup on another disk. The first run copies everything. Every later run only copies what has **changed**, so a weekly backup usually takes just seconds or minutes.

Oborcopy works with two modes:

Mode	What it does	Typical use
Update	Copies new and changed files to the destination. **Nothing is ever deleted** in the destination.	Collecting files, "add only" backups
Mirror	Like Update, and in addition **deletes files in the destination that no longer exist in the source**. Afterwards both folders are identical.	An exact backup of your music, photos or documents

> **Example:** You removed an album from your music collection. With **Update** the album stays on the backup disk. With **Mirror** it is also removed from the backup disk – but only after Oborcopy has shown you the list and you have confirmed it.

Words used in this guide:

- **Source** – the folder you want to back up (e.g. `D:\Music`).
- **Destination** – the folder that receives the copy (e.g. `E:\Music`).
- **Job** – a saved set of settings: source, destination, mode and options. You can save as many jobs as you like.

2. Installation

Oborcopy does not need an installer. You unpack it and start it.

2.1 Windows 10 / 11

1. Unpack `Oborcopy-1.0.0-win64.zip` to a folder of your choice, for example `C:\Tools\Oborcopy`.
2. Double-click **`Oborcopy.exe`**.
3. *Optional:* right-click `Oborcopy.exe` → **Show more options** → **Send to** → **Desktop (create shortcut)**.

> **Note:** Keep all files of the folder together – the DLL files and sub-folders are needed.
>
> If Windows shows "*Windows protected your PC*" (SmartScreen) the first time, click **More info** → **Run anyway**. This appears for programs downloaded from the internet that are not signed by a publisher.

2.2 Linux

Requirements: 64-bit Linux, as new as Ubuntu 24.04 or newer (e.g. Linux Mint 22, Debian 13, Fedora 40), with a normal desktop. Everything else is included.

1. Unpack the archive in a terminal:

   ```
   tar xzf oborcopy-1.0.0-linux-x86_64.tar.gz
   ```

2. Start Oborcopy:

   ```
   cd oborcopy-1.0.0-linux-x86_64
   ./oborcopy
   ```

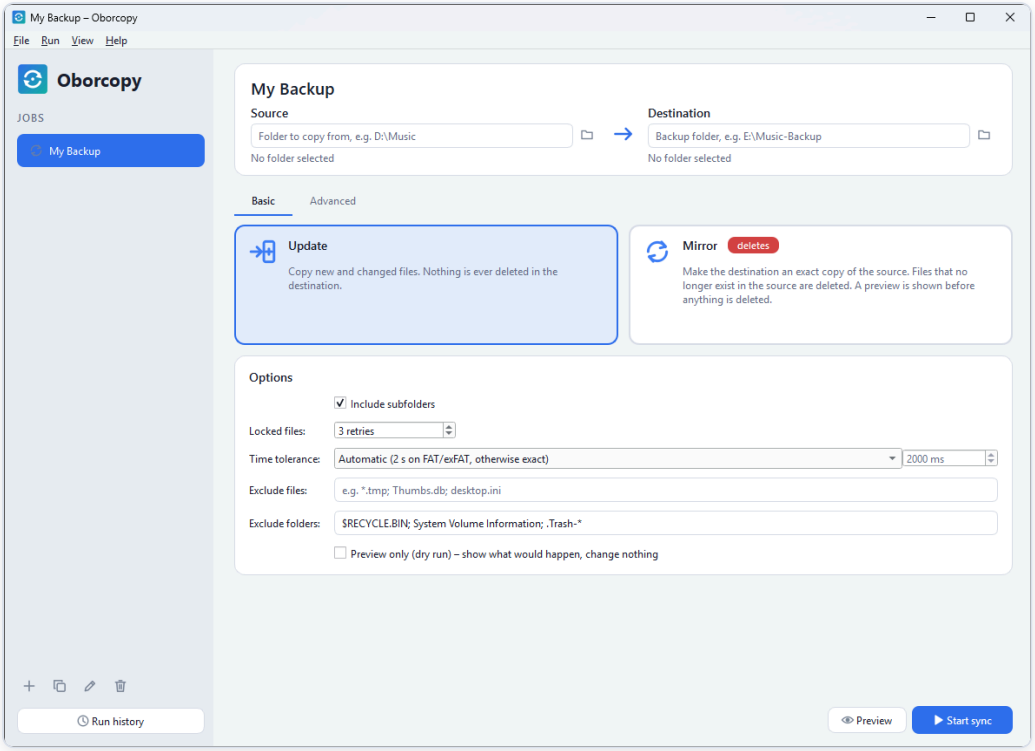
3. *Optional:* add Oborcopy to your application menu:

   ```
   ./install-desktop-entry.sh
   ```

   (Run it again if you move the folder later.)

3. Quick start – your first backup in 6 steps

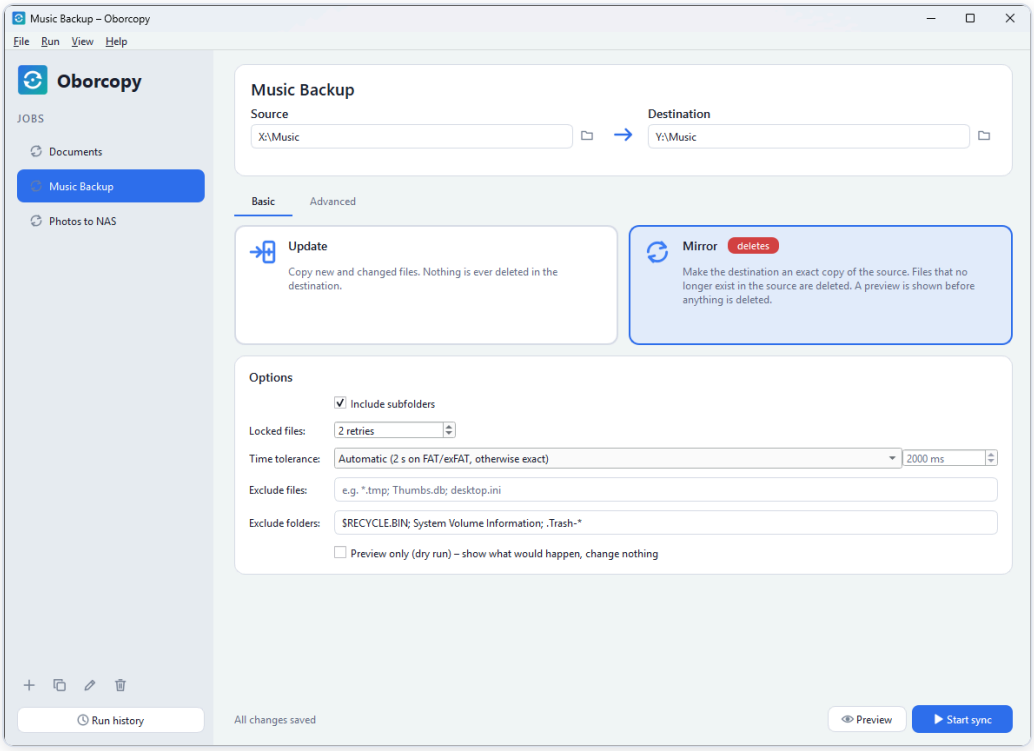
When you start Oborcopy for the first time, it creates an empty job called **My Backup**:



1. **Source:** click the folder icon next to *Source* and choose the folder you want to back up (e.g. your music folder).
2. **Destination:** click the folder icon next to *Destination* and choose the folder on your backup disk. It may be empty or not exist yet.
3. **Mode:** click the card **Update** (never deletes) or **Mirror** (exact copy).
4. **Preview:** click **Preview** at the bottom right. Oborcopy shows what it *would* do – nothing is changed yet. Close the preview.
5. **Start:** click **Start sync**. In Mirror mode you confirm the deletions once more (see section 6.3).
6. **Result:** at the end you see a summary such as "*1,204 files checked, 37 copied, 12 updated, 7 deleted, 0 errors*". Click **Show details** for the full list.

That's it. Your settings are saved automatically – next week you only click **Start sync** again.

4. The main window



Area	What you find there
Sidebar (left)	Your jobs. Click a job to open it. The buttons below the list create **(+)**, duplicate, rename and delete jobs. **Run history** shows earlier runs.
Job header (top)	The job name, **Source** and **Destination**. Below each folder Oborcopy shows information about the disk, e.g. "*exFAT · 412 GB free of 1.8 TB · 2 s timestamps*".
Basic tab	The mode cards **Update** / **Mirror** and the most important options. Most users never need more.
Advanced tab	All further options, grouped into sections (section 8).
Action bar (bottom)	**Preview** and **Start sync**. While a sync is running: **Pause/Resume** and **Cancel**. On the left a status text, e.g. "*All changes saved*".
Menu bar	*File* (new job, save, run history, log folder, exit), *Run* (start, preview, pause, cancel), *View* (theme), *Help* (About).

4.1 Choosing folders

There are three ways to enter a folder:

- click the **folder icon** and pick the folder,
- **type or paste** the path into the field, or
- **drag a folder** from Explorer / your file manager **onto the field**.

4.2 The Basic options

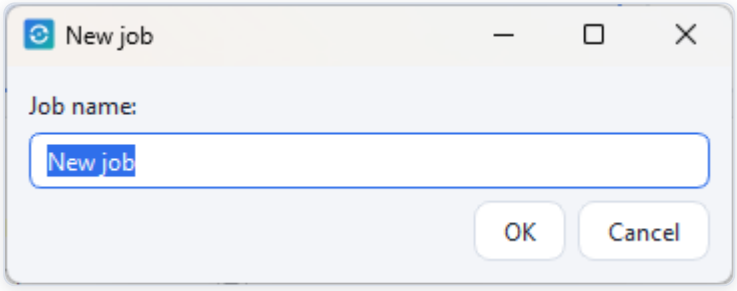
Option	Meaning	Recommendation
Include subfolders	Also copy everything inside sub-folders.	On
Locked files	How often a file that is in use by another program is tried again. The wait grows each time (2 s, 4 s, 8 s …).	3 retries
Time tolerance	How exact the file times must match to count as "unchanged". *Automatic* allows 2 seconds on FAT/exFAT disks (USB sticks, many external disks) – otherwise every file would look changed.	Automatic
Exclude files	Files that are skipped, separated by `;`. Wildcards: `*` = any text, `?` = one character. Example: `*.tmp; Thumbs.db; desktop.ini`	as needed
Exclude folders	Folders that are skipped. Windows system folders are excluded already.	keep the defaults
Preview only (dry run)	Every run only shows what would happen – nothing is changed.	Off

> **Good to know:** Excluded files are neither copied nor deleted – also not in Mirror mode.

5. Managing jobs

A **job** stores everything about one backup task. Create one job per task, e.g. *Music Backup*, *Photos to NAS*, *Documents*.

Action	How
Create a job	Click **+** below the job list (or *File* → *New job…*, `Ctrl+N`) and enter a name.
Open a job	Click it in the list.
Rename	Double-click the job, or click the pencil button.
Duplicate	Select the job and click the duplicate button – useful for a second backup disk with the same settings.
Delete	Click the trash button. Only the job settings are removed – **no files are touched**.
Save	Not needed: every change is saved automatically within a second.

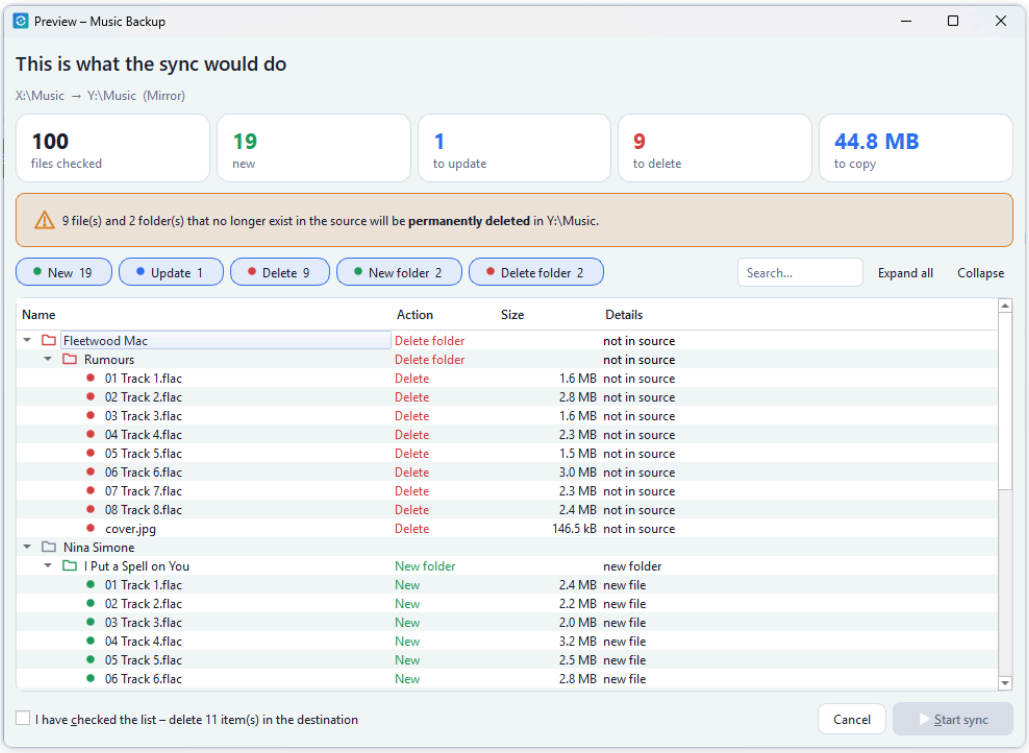


6. Step by step: running a sync

The following example uses the job **Music Backup** in **Mirror** mode: the music collection on `X:\Music` is mirrored to the backup disk `Y:\Music`. Since the last backup two albums were added, one track was re-ripped and one album was removed.

6.1 Preview – see what will happen

Click **Preview** (or press `F6`). Oborcopy scans both folders and compares them. **Nothing is changed.**



At the top you see the numbers: files checked, **new** files, files **to update**, files **to delete**, and how much data will be copied.

Below is a **folder tree** with every planned action:

- ● **New** – the file does not exist in the destination yet.
- ● **Update** – the file exists but is different (newer, older or a different size).
- ● **Delete** – the file exists only in the destination (Mirror mode only).

The coloured buttons above the tree (*New 19*, *Update 1*, *Delete 9*, …) are **filters**: click one to hide or show that kind of entry. Use **Search…** to find a file, **Expand all / Collapse** to open or close the folders.

If everything looks right you can click **Start sync** directly in the preview – or **Cancel** to go back without changes.

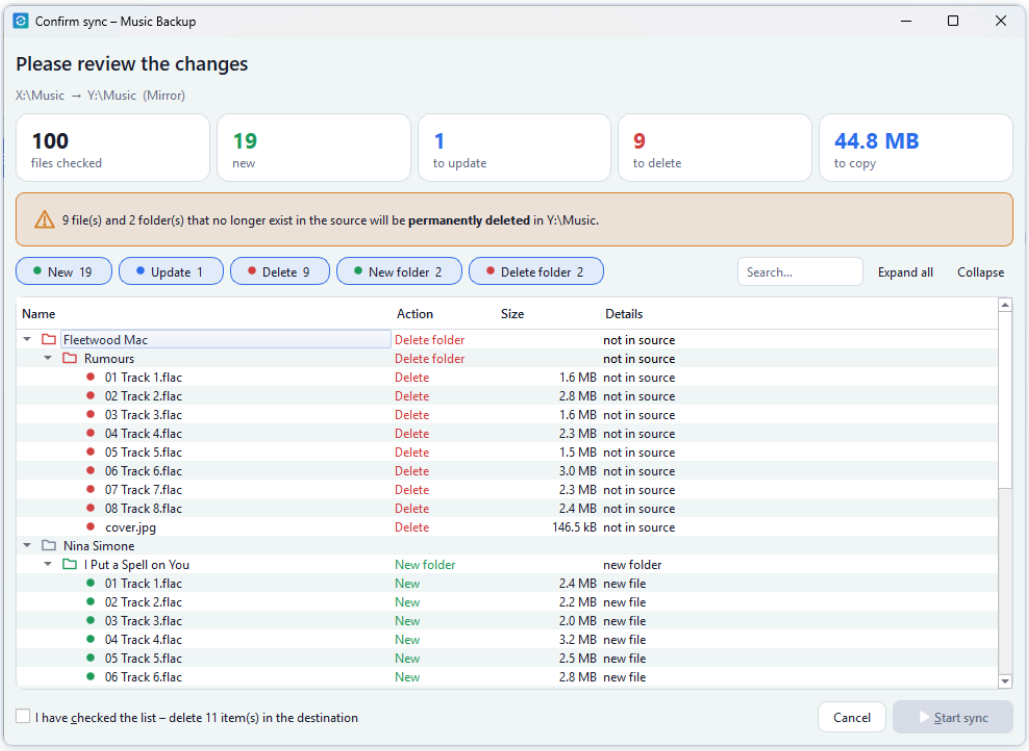
> **Tip:** If the preview says "*Everything is up to date*", there is nothing to do.

6.2 Starting the sync

Click **Start sync** (or press `F5`).

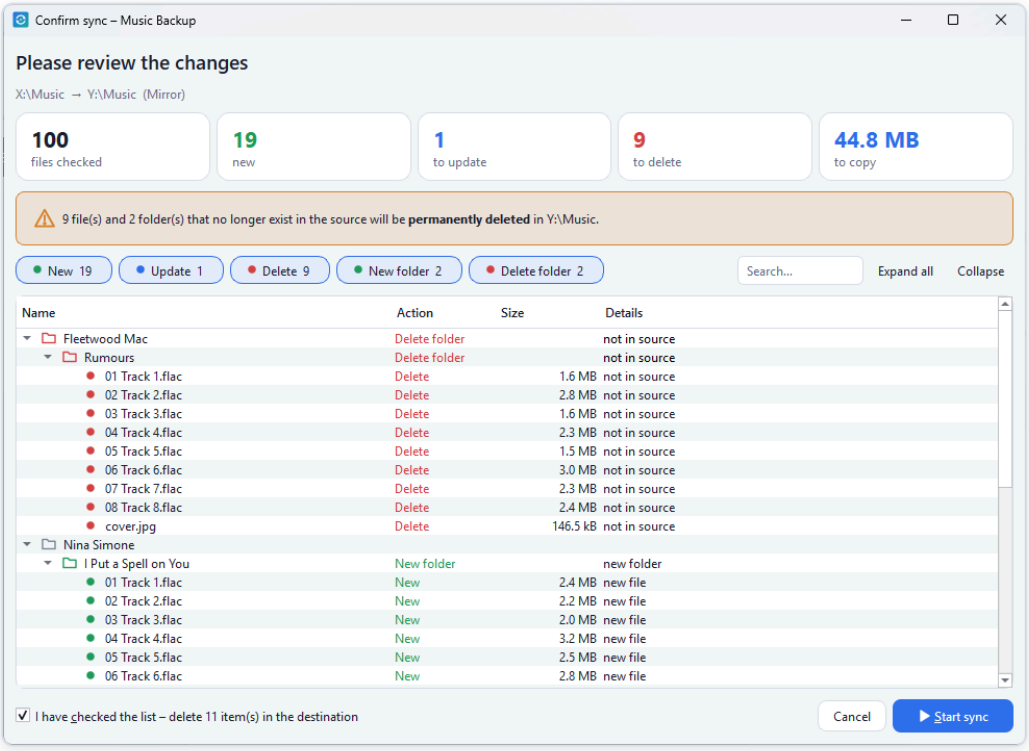
- In **Update** mode, or when nothing has to be deleted, the sync starts immediately.
- In **Mirror** mode with deletions, Oborcopy first shows the confirmation window.

6.3 Confirming a Mirror sync



This window looks like the preview. The orange box tells you **how many files and folders will be deleted** and **where**. The **Start sync** button stays grey until you tick the box at the bottom:

☑ I have checked the list – delete 11 item(s) in the destination

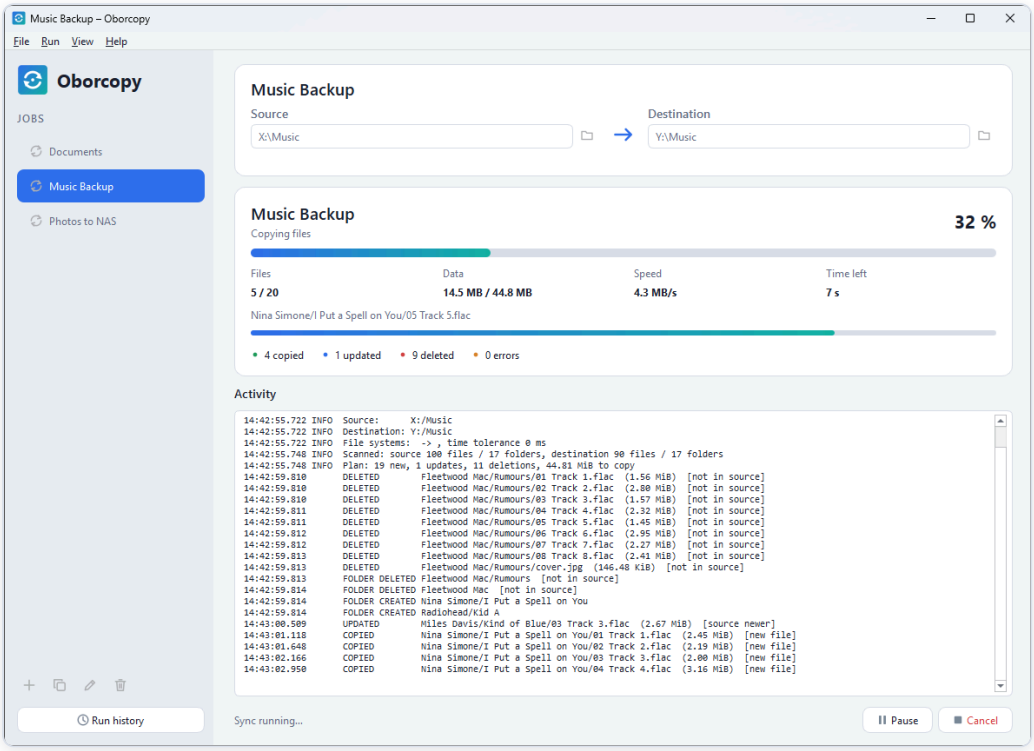


Then click **Start sync**.

> **Red warning?** If a large part of the backup would be deleted (more than 20 % by default), Oborcopy shows an additional **red warning**. This usually means that the **wrong source folder** was selected or that the **source disk is not connected**. Click **Cancel** and check the source first.

6.4 Watching the progress

While the sync is running, the options are replaced by the progress view:

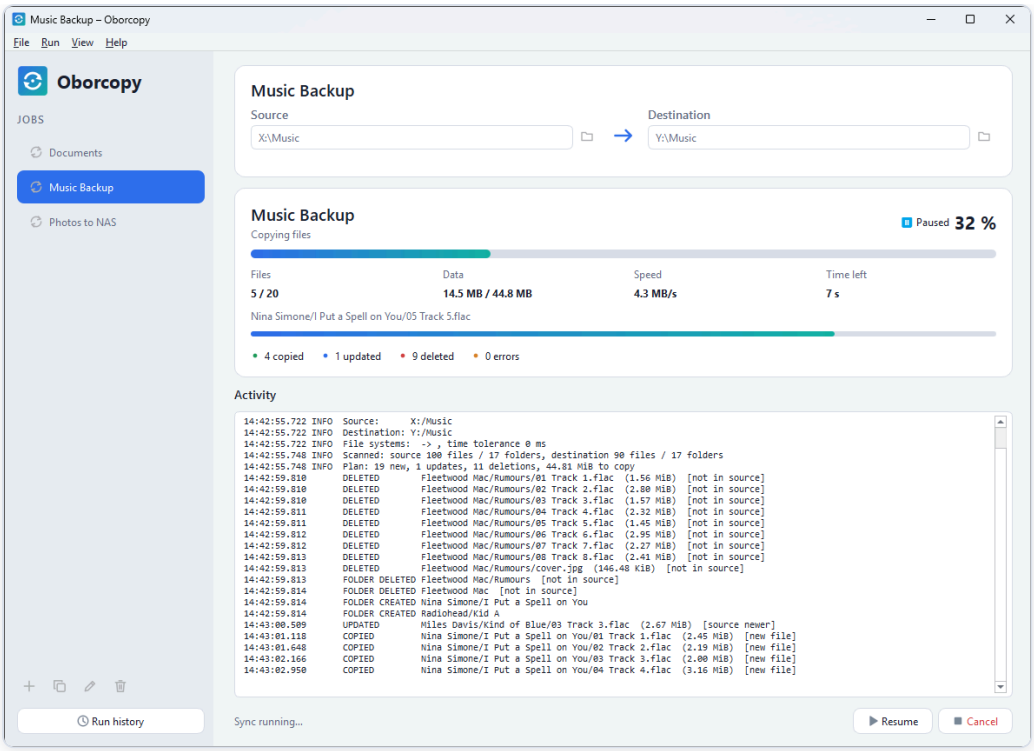


- **Percentage and bar** – overall progress (by amount of data).
- **Files** – files copied so far / files to copy.
- **Data**, **Speed**, **Time left** – amount copied, current speed and estimated remaining time.
- **Current file** with its own small progress bar.
- **Counters** – copied, updated, deleted, errors so far.
- **Activity** – a live list of everything Oborcopy does.

You can keep using your computer – Oborcopy stays responsive the whole time.

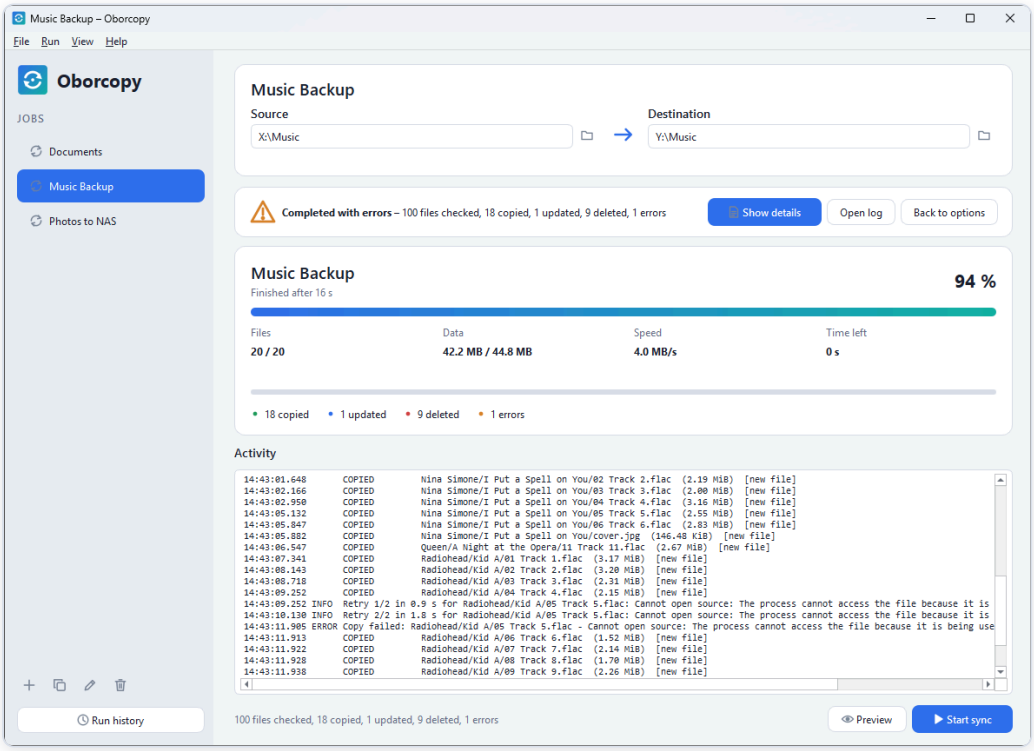
6.5 Pause, resume or cancel

- **Pause** (`F7`) – stops copying after the current block of data; the button changes to **Resume**. Useful if you need the full disk speed for something else for a moment.
- **Cancel** (`Shift+F5`) – stops the sync. Files already copied stay in the destination; the file that was being copied is discarded, so there are **never half-copied files** in your backup. Simply start the sync again later – Oborcopy continues where it stopped.



6.6 The result

When the sync is done, a result line appears at the top:



Symbol	Meaning
Green check ✓	**Completed** – everything worked.
Orange triangle ⚠	**Completed with errors** – most files were copied, some could not be (see section 7.2).
Grey square ■	**Cancelled** – you stopped the sync.

Symbol	Meaning
Red cross ✕	**Failed** – the sync could not run (e.g. the source folder does not exist). The reason is shown.

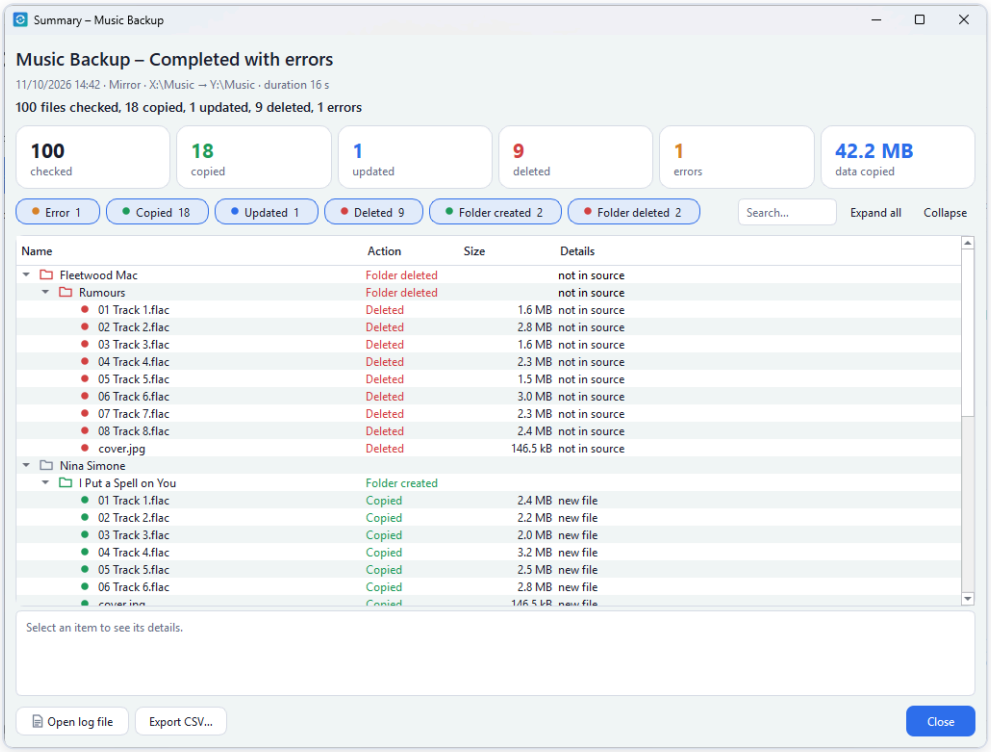
Buttons:

- **Show details** – opens the detailed summary (section 7).
- **Open log** – opens the log file of this run in a text editor.
- **Back to options** – returns to the job settings.

7. Reading the results

7.1 The detailed summary

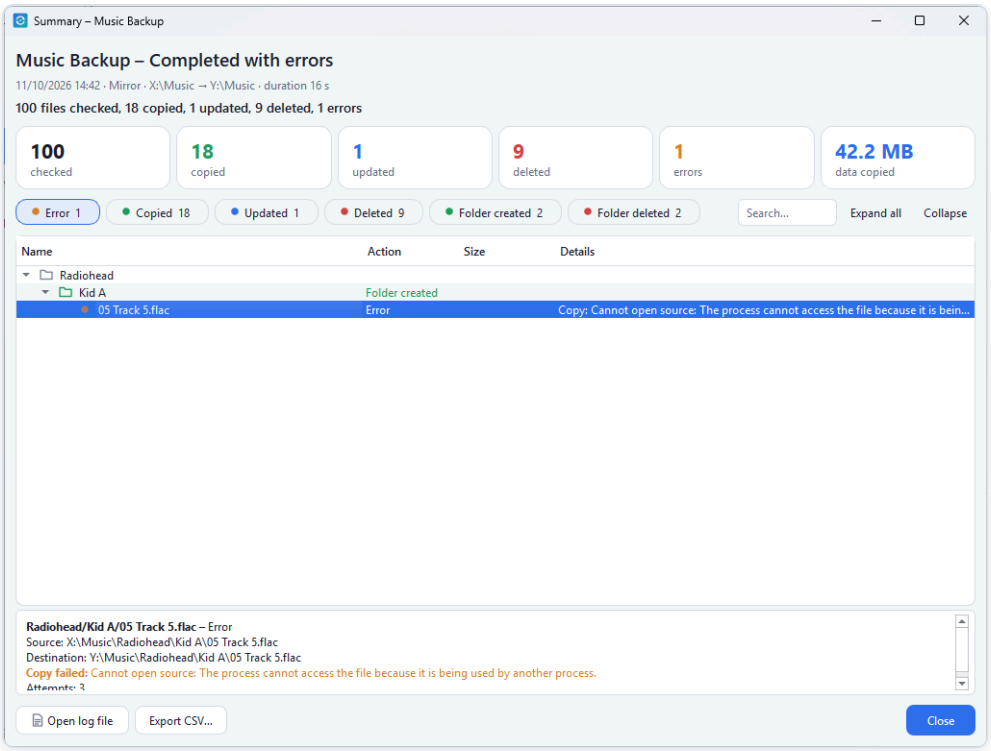
Click **Show details** after a sync, or open any earlier run from the **Run history**.



- **Top:** job name and result, date, mode, folders and duration, then the summary line, e.g. "*100 files checked, 18 copied, 1 updated, 9 deleted, 1 errors*".
- **Tiles:** checked, copied, updated, deleted, errors and amount of data copied.
- **Filter buttons:** *Error*, *Copied*, *Updated*, *Deleted*, *Folder created*, *Folder deleted* – click to show or hide each group.
- **Folder tree:** every file that was copied, updated or deleted, in its folder.
- **Details area (bottom):** click an entry to see the full source and destination path, size and reason.
- **Open log file** / **Export CSV...** – the CSV file opens in Excel or LibreOffice Calc.

7.2 Understanding errors

An error means that one file could not be processed – **all other files were still synced**. To see only the errors, switch off all filter buttons except **Error**, then click the file:



The details show what was attempted, the message from the operating system and how many attempts were made. In this example the file was **open in another program** ("being used by another process"); Oborcopy tried 3 times and then moved on.

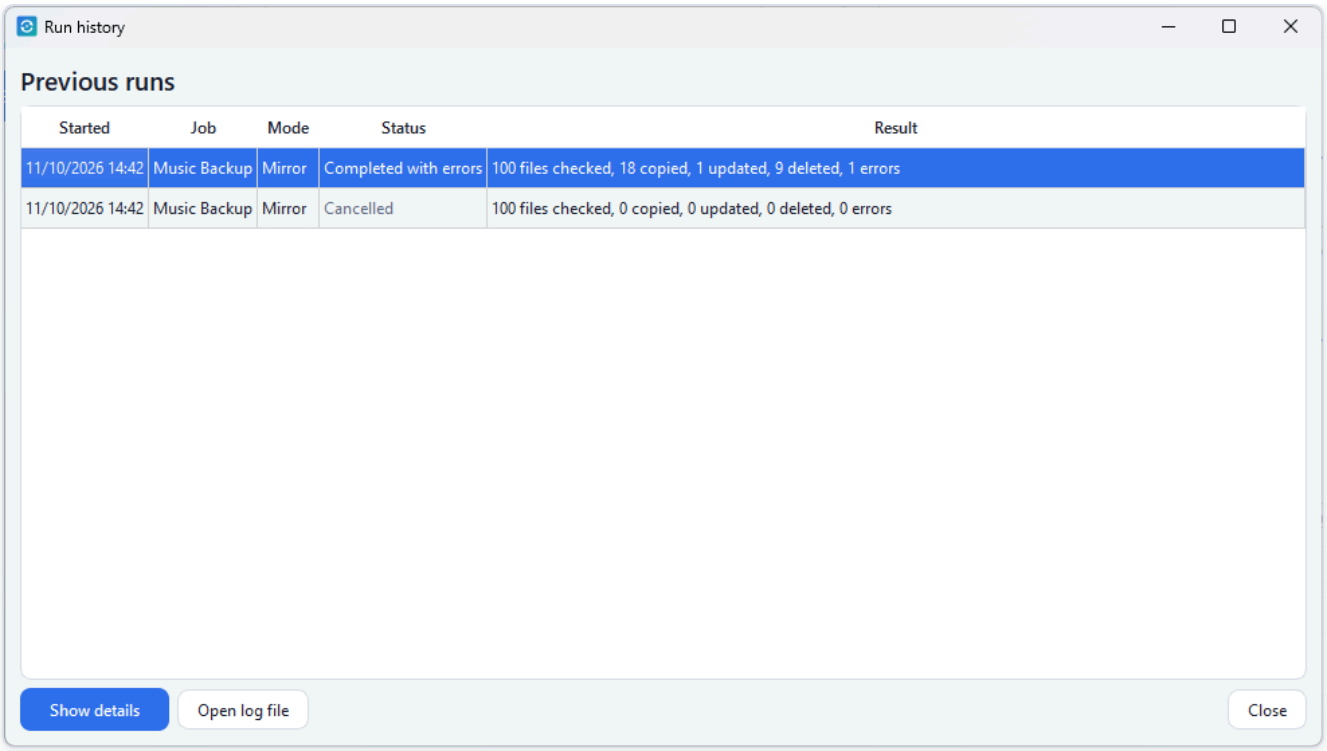
What to do: close the program that uses the file (or wait until it is finished) and simply run the sync again. Only the missing file will be copied.

Common messages:

Message	Cause	Solution
being used by another process	The file is open in another program.	Close the program, run again. Increase *Locked files* retries if it happens often.
Access is denied / *Permission denied*	No permission to read the source or write the destination.	Check the folder permissions; on Windows, the file may be read-only on a protected location.
Source file no longer exists	The file was deleted or moved while the sync was running.	Nothing to do.
No space left on device / disk full	The destination disk is full.	Free space or use a bigger disk. The preview warns about this in advance.

7.3 Run history

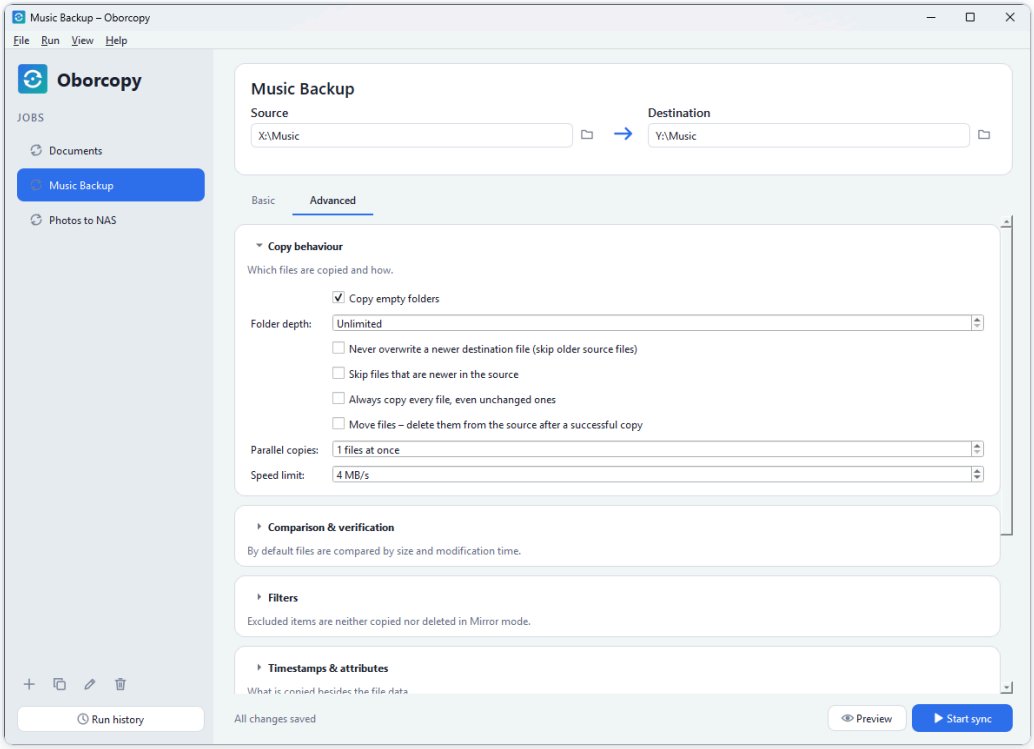
Click **Run history** in the sidebar (or *File* → *Run history…*, `Ctrl+H`) to see all earlier runs of all jobs:



Select a run and click **Show details** (or double-click it) to open its summary, or **Open log file** to read its log.

8. Advanced options

The **Advanced** tab contains the remaining options in sections. Click a section title to open or close it. The defaults are chosen so that you normally don't need to change anything here.



8.1 Copy behaviour

Option	Meaning
Copy empty folders	Also create folders that contain no files.
Folder depth	*Unlimited*, or only the first *n* folder levels (1 = only the files directly in the source folder).
Never overwrite a newer destination file	If the file in the destination is newer than the source, keep it.
Skip files that are newer in the source	Only copy new files and files that became older (rarely needed).
Always copy every file	Copy everything, even unchanged files (slow – for special cases).
Move files	Delete each file from the **source** after it was copied successfully. ⚠ Use with care.
Parallel copies	Copy several files at the same time. Helpful for SSDs and network drives; for normal hard disks 1 is usually fastest.
Speed limit	Limit the copy speed in MB/s, e.g. to keep a network usable. *Unlimited* = full speed. (In the screenshot a limit of 4 MB/s is set.)

8.2 Comparison & verification

Option	Meaning
Ignore exact 1-hour differences	Prevents re-copying everything after the switch to/from daylight saving time on FAT disks. Turn on if you see all files being "updated" twice a year.
Compare file contents (SHA-256)	Also compares the actual contents of files that look unchanged. Finds silent changes, but reads every file – much slower.
Verify every copied file	After copying, the copy is read again and compared with the original. Recommended for very valuable data; takes about twice as long.

8.3 Filters

Option	Meaning
Only files	Copy only matching files, e.g. `*.mp3; *.flac`. Empty = all files.
Minimum / Maximum size	Skip files that are smaller / larger than the given size (MB).
Skip files newer / older than	Skip files by age in days.
Skip hidden / system files	Skip hidden files and folders, or Windows system files.
Links	Skip symbolic links and junctions (default) or follow them and copy their target.

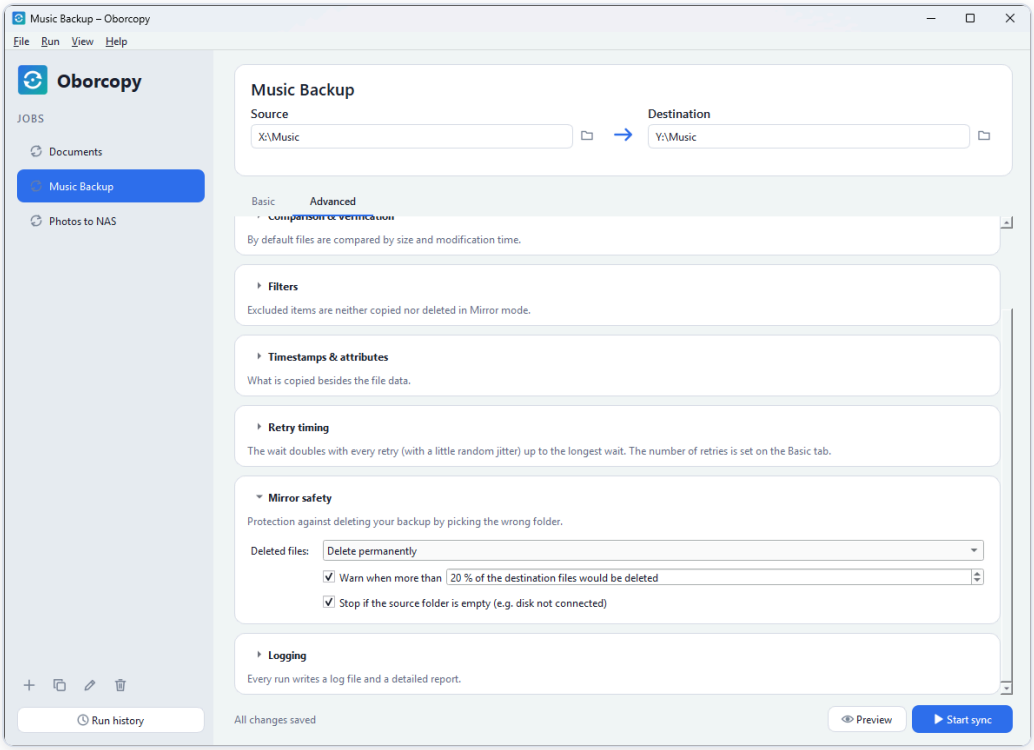
8.4 Timestamps & attributes

Keep **file modification times** switched on – Oborcopy needs them to recognise unchanged files next time. Folder times, Windows attributes (read-only, hidden …) and Linux permissions can also be kept.

8.5 Retry timing

First wait (default 2 s) and **Longest wait** (default 60 s) for locked files. The wait doubles with every attempt. The number of attempts is set on the Basic tab.

8.6 Mirror safety



Option	Meaning
Deleted files	*Delete permanently* (default), or *Move to archive folder*: deleted files are moved into the folder `.oborcopy-archive` in the destination (sorted by date and time) instead of being deleted. You can restore them from there or delete the archive later yourself.
Warn when more than … % … would be deleted	Shows a red warning in the confirmation window (and stops automatic command-line runs) when many files would be deleted. Default 20 %.
Stop if the source folder is empty	Prevents wiping your backup when the source disk is not connected. Keep it on.

8.7 Logging

Option	Meaning
Log folder	Where log files are stored. Empty = default location (section 11).
Detail	*Summary only*, *Changes* (every copied/updated/deleted file – recommended) or *All files* (also unchanged files – large logs).
Keep logs of the last	Older logs of this job are deleted automatically (default: 50 runs).

9. Weekly backups – the recommended routine

For a music collection (or photos, documents …) with one backup disk:

Once – set up the job

1. Create a job, e.g. *Music Backup*.
2. Source = your music folder, Destination = a folder on the backup disk.
3. Choose **Mirror**.
4. *Optional:* Advanced → Mirror safety → **Move to archive folder** for extra safety.

Every week

1. Connect the backup disk.
2. Start Oborcopy, select the job.
3. Click **Start sync**.
4. If files will be deleted, look at the list in the confirmation window. Are these really files you removed on purpose? Then tick the box and click **Start sync**.
5. Check the result line. If it shows errors, open **Show details**.
6. Safely remove ("eject") the backup disk.

> **Tip:** Keep a second backup disk at another place (e.g. at work or with family) and create a second job for it with **Duplicate**.

10. Automatic backups with the command line

Besides the window program, Oborcopy includes the command-line tool `oborcopy-cli`. It runs a saved job without a window – ideal for automatic backups.

10.1 Commands

Example: `oborcopy-cli --job "Music Backup" --yes` runs the job *Music Backup* and allows deletions.

Option	Meaning
`--list-jobs`	Show all saved jobs.
`--job "Name"`	Run the saved job with this name.
`--job-file file.json`	Run a job from a JSON file.
`--dry-run`	Only show what would happen.
`--yes`	Allow deletions in Mirror mode. **Without it, a Mirror run with deletions is stopped** – a safety measure.
`--force`	Run even if the "too many deletions" warning applies.
`--quiet` / `--verbose`	Less / more output.
`--help`	Show all options.

When it finishes, `oborcopy-cli` returns a **result code**: 0 = nothing to do, 1 = files copied, 2 = files deleted, 3 = both, 8 = some files failed, 16 = the run could not be done or was stopped.

10.2 Windows: weekly backup with the Task Scheduler

1. Press the **Windows key**, type **Task Scheduler** and open it.
2. Click **Create Basic Task...** on the right.
3. Name: *Oborcopy Music Backup* → **Next**.
4. Trigger: **Weekly** → **Next** → choose the day and time (e.g. Sunday 20:00) → **Next**.
5. Action: **Start a program** → **Next**.
6. *Program/script:* browse to `oborcopy-cli.exe` (e.g. `C:\Tools\Oborcopy\oborcopy-cli.exe`). *Add arguments:* `--job "Music Backup" --yes --quiet` *Start in:* the Oborcopy folder (e.g. `C:\Tools\Oborcopy`) → **Next** → **Finish**.

Make sure the backup disk is connected at that time. Each automatic run appears in Oborcopy's **Run history** with its full summary.

10.3 Linux: weekly backup with cron

Open the cron table with `crontab -e` and add this line (Sunday 20:00 – use the path where you unpacked Oborcopy):

```
0 20 * * 0  /opt/oborcopy/oborcopy-cli --job "Music Backup" --yes --quiet
```

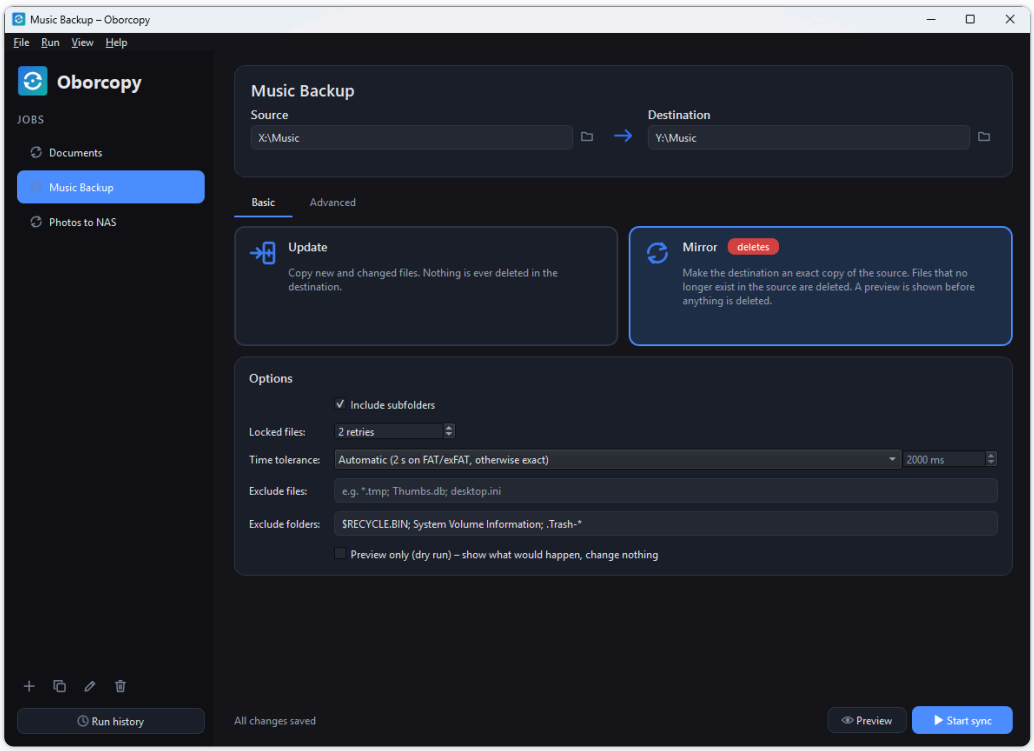
11. Settings, log files and where things are stored

What	Windows	Linux
Jobs	`%LOCALAPPDATA%\Oborcopy\jobs\`	`~/.config/Oborcopy/jobs/`
Program settings (theme, window size)	`%LOCALAPPDATA%\Oborcopy\settings.json`	`~/.config/Oborcopy/settings.json`
Log files and run reports	`%LOCALAPPDATA%\Oborcopy\logs\`	`~/.local/share/Oborcopy/logs/`

- *File → Open log folder* opens the log folder directly.
- Each run writes a readable `.log` file and a `.json` report (used for the Run history).
- To **back up or move your jobs** to another computer, copy the `jobs` folder.
- **Portable use:** if the environment variable `OBORCOPY_CONFIG_DIR` points to a folder (e.g. on a USB stick), Oborcopy stores everything there.

11.1 Light and dark theme

Choose *View → Theme → System, Light* or *Dark*. *System* follows the setting of your operating system.



12. How Oborcopy protects your data

Oborcopy is designed so that a mistake does not destroy your backup:

1. **Look before you act** – everything is compared first; nothing is changed before you start the sync.
2. **Confirmation of deletions** – Mirror mode shows every file that will be deleted and requires your confirmation.
3. **Too-many-deletions warning** – a red warning when an unusually large part of the backup would be deleted.
4. **Empty source protection** – if the source folder is empty (e.g. disk not connected), the sync is stopped.
5. **Folder check** – the destination may not be the same as the source or lie inside it.
6. **No half-copied files** – each file is first written under a temporary name and only renamed when it is complete. Even a power failure leaves no broken files behind.
7. **Archive instead of delete** – optionally, deleted files are kept in `.oborcopy-archive`.
8. **Retries** – files that are briefly in use are tried again automatically.
9. **Logs** – every run is documented.

13. Questions and troubleshooting

The first sync takes long – is that normal? Yes. The first run copies everything. Later runs only copy changes and are much faster.

Every sync copies all files again. Why?

- Check Advanced → *Timestamps & attributes* → **Keep file modification times** is on.
- Keep *Time tolerance* on **Automatic** (needed for FAT/exFAT disks).
- If it happens after the clock change in spring/autumn, turn on **Ignore exact 1-hour differences** (Advanced → Comparison).

Oborcopy says "The source folder is empty but the destination is not". The source disk is probably not connected or the wrong folder is selected. This protection prevents your backup from being wiped. Check the source folder.

How do I restore files from my backup? The backup is a normal folder with normal files – simply copy the files back with Explorer / your file manager. Or create a job with the backup as source and your original location as destination (use **Update** mode to be safe).

Can I use network drives or a NAS? Yes – choose the network folder like any other folder (e.g. `\\nas\backup` on Windows or a mounted share on Linux). *Parallel copies* (Advanced) can make network copies faster.

I renamed a file only in upper/lower case (e.g. `song.mp3` → `Song.mp3`). On Windows this is not treated as a change; the file is not copied again.

Can I keep using the computer during a sync? Yes. Use **Pause** if you need the full disk speed for a moment.

Linux: "could not load the Qt platform plugin xcb". Install the basic graphics libraries of your distribution, e.g. on Ubuntu: `sudo apt install libgl1 libegl1 libxkbcommon-x11-0 libfontconfig1`

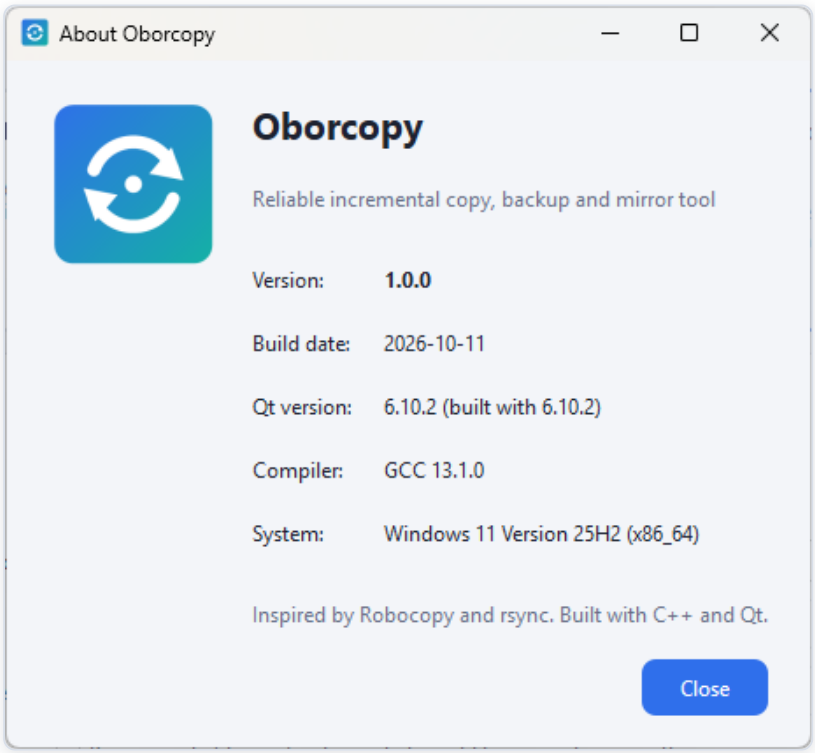
Where do I find out what happened in an automatic run? Open Oborcopy → **Run history**, or look into the log folder.

14. Keyboard shortcuts and version

Key	Action
`F5`	Start sync
`F6`	Preview
`F7`	Pause / Resume
`Shift+F5`	Cancel the running sync
`Ctrl+N`	New job
`Ctrl+S`	Save job (also happens automatically)
`Ctrl+H`	Run history
`Alt+F4`	Exit (Windows; on Linux also `Ctrl+Q`)
`Alt+C`, `Alt+S`	In the confirmation window: tick the check box, start the sync

14.1 Version information

Help → About Oborcopy shows the version, the build date and technical details – please include them when you report a problem.



15. Glossary

Term	Explanation
Source	The folder that is backed up. Oborcopy only reads from it (except with *Move files*).
Destination	The folder that receives the copy.
Job	Saved settings for one backup task.
Update mode	Copies new and changed files; never deletes.
Mirror mode	Makes the destination identical to the source, including deletions.
Preview / Dry run	Shows what would happen without changing anything.
Extra file	A file that exists in the destination but not (anymore) in the source.
FAT / exFAT	File systems used by USB sticks and many external disks; they store file times in 2-second steps.
Time tolerance	How much file times may differ and still count as equal.
Archive folder	`.oborcopy-archive` in the destination – receives deleted files if this option is on.
Log file	Text file with everything that happened during a run.